the West Bank caused international concern, and in 2005, Israel finally withdrew its troops and settlers from Gaza.

The following year, the militant Sunni Islamic organization Hamas took control of the Gaza Strip. This led to an Israeli blockade on its borders with the Gaza Strip, which prevented people and goods from crossing in either direction, leading some people to describe the Gaza Strip as an "open-air prison." In 2023, Hamas fighters suddenly launched a massive rocket attack on Israel from the Gaza Strip, killing many civilians, that prompted a retaliatory Israeli military action. This current conflict can be traced back directly to the 1948 war.

The armistice agreements that ended the 1948 war led to the creation of the modern State of Israel. Unfortunately, these agreements did not lead to lasting peace in the region. Just seven years after the conclusion of the war, conflict arose again when a new Egyptian president, Gamal Abdel Nasser, announced that the Suez Canal was to be nationalized. This prompted military intervention in Egypt by Britain and France, who negotiated an agreement with Israel to conduct a simultaneous ground assault on Egypt's Sinai Peninsula. The IDF had come so far in terms of training, equipment, and numbers that it was able to mount a successful invasion and occupy most of this strategically vital region. While the Israelis eventually had to withdraw from the Sinai under the terms of the peace agreement, they were able to force Egypt to agree to open the Straits of Tiran, the narrow sea passage that links the Gulf of Aqaba and the Red Sea, to Israeli shipping.

When, in 1967, Egypt once again attempted to close the Straits of Tiran to Israeli shipping, a new conflict erupted—the Six-Day War, in which the IDF simultaneously attacked Egypt, Jordan, and Syria. A rapid victory in this war left Israel occupying even more territory (including the West Bank and the Gaza Strip) and saw a new temporary border established—the "Purple Line," which superseded the Green Line agreed upon after the 1948 war. This time, peace lasted until October 1973 when Egypt and Syria, supported by other Arab nations, launched a surprise attack on Israel. This conflict, the Yom Kippur War, led to little territorial change, and the IDF was again able to defeat the invading Arab armies.

After large-scale conflicts between Israel and its Arab neighbors in 1948, 1956, 1967, and 1973, there have been no further concerted